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CUET UG

Business Studies

Directing

Official Syllabus Unit VII · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Business Studies syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline, Unit VII)	Skills the questions test
Meaning, importance, principles; supervision	Meaning, importance and principles; Supervision – meaning and importance.	Stating directing as instructing-guiding-motivating, listing its importance points, and explaining the supervisor's link role between workers and management.
Motivation and Maslow	Motivation – meaning and importance, Maslow's hierarchy of needs.	Ordering the five need levels bottom-up, applying "a satisfied need no longer motivates", and matching an incentive to the rung it feeds.
Incentives	Financial and non-financial incentives.	Classifying a named incentive as financial or non-financial — and knowing which rungs each family reaches.
Leadership styles	Leadership – meaning, importance, style-authoritative, democratic and laissez-faire.	Matching a described manager's behaviour to authoritative, democratic or laissez-faire style, with the strengths and costs of each.
Communication and barriers	Communication – meaning and importance, formal and informal communication; barriers to effective communication, how to overcome the barriers.	Separating formal channels from the grapevine, naming the four barrier families (semantic, psychological, organisational, personal) and pairing each barrier with its remedy.

EXAM PATTERN

CUET UG pattern (NTA official information bulletin and syllabus, 2026 cycle — the current 2027 baseline): each subject paper carries **50 compulsory questions** in **60 minutes**, with +5 for every correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer. Unit VII carries four self-contained topics — supervision, motivation, leadership, communication — and questions lean on Maslow's order, incentive classification and barrier-remedy pairing.

What Directing Actually Is

Plans exist, people are hired and trained, the structure is drawn — and still nothing happens until someone **starts** the engine. Directing is that starting and steering: instructing people what to do, explaining how, motivating them to want to, leading them through change, and keeping the words flowing so that everyone stays aligned. It is the function that touches people **directly** — which is why it never stops.

- **Definition:** directing means **instructing, guiding, counselling, motivating and leading** people in the organisation so that they act willingly toward the organisation's goals.
- **It is executive:** directing flows from **every** manager to **every** subordinate — at every level where authority exists.
- **It is continuous:** orders, encouragement and feedback are needed as long as the organisation runs; direction is not an event but a habit.

Why directing matters — the importance

- **Initiates action:** all other functions prepare; direction **sets the wheels moving** — work begins only when people are told, shown and motivated.
- **Integrates employee efforts:** individual efforts are coordinated toward one goal through guidance and leadership.
- **Means of motivation:** direction carries the incentives, recognition and encouragement that make employees give their best.
- **Helps realise potential:** good guidance draws out abilities employees did not know they had — capacity becomes performance.
- **Supports change:** when the firm must change, direction and leadership help employees accept it willingly rather than resist it.
- **Brings stability and balance:** continuous contact, counseling and fair handling of grievances keep the workplace steady even in hard times.

Supervision — The Supervisor on the Floor

Directing reaches the shop floor through the **supervisor** — the first-line manager who watches the work as it happens, shows the way, and speaks for both sides.

- **Meaning:** supervision means **overseeing the work** of subordinates as it is performed — guiding them on the spot, checking the flow, keeping standards.

- **The supervisor's position:** the **link between workers and management** — orders travel down through the supervisor; complaints and suggestions travel up through the supervisor.
- **Improves morale:** a helpful supervisor solves small problems before they grow, so workers stay confident and willing.
- **Continuous feedback:** the supervisor sees quality, speed and attitude as they happen — the fastest feedback channel the firm owns.
- **Good working relations:** fair supervision builds trust between the floor and the office — fewer disputes, smoother days.

Motivation — Making People Want to Act

You can order attendance; you cannot order enthusiasm. Motivation is the process that makes people **want** to give their best — and the syllabus pins it to one famous ladder.

- **Definition:** motivation is the process of **stimulating people to act** to accomplish goals — needs create drives, drives create action.
- **The mechanism:** an **unsatisfied need** creates tension → the person acts to satisfy it → satisfaction relieves the tension — and that need stops motivating, because it is met.

Maslow's hierarchy — the five rungs



Figure 1: Figure 1 — Maslow's hierarchy of needs: five rungs climbed bottom-up, with the ways firms feed each rung and the climb rule that governs motivation.

- **1. Physiological (basic) needs:** food, clothing, shelter — the base salary and canteen feed this rung.
- **2. Safety and security needs:** physical safety, job security, pension and insurance — protection against the future.

- **3. Social needs:** belonging, affection, friendship — a warm team and a welcoming workplace feed this rung.
- **4. Esteem needs:** self-respect, recognition, status — titles, awards and praise feed this rung.
- **5. Self-actualisation:** realising one's fullest potential — challenging work, growth and autonomy feed the top rung.
- **The climb rule:** people climb **bottom to top** — a **satisfied need no longer motivates**; the next unmet rung becomes the pull.

Financial incentives

- **Pay and allowances:** the basic salary plus dearness and other allowances — the foundation incentive.
- **Bonus and profit-sharing:** extra cash tied to results — a share of what the success produced.
- **Co-partnership and stock options:** employees become owners in part — dividends and rising shares join the pay packet.
- **Perquisites:** car, house, paid holidays, laptop — benefits beyond cash.
- **Retirement benefits:** provident fund and pension — security for the years after work.

Non-financial incentives

- **Status:** a higher designation and its visible marks — rank itself motivates.
- **Career growth and promotion chances:** a visible ladder ahead — effort today becomes tomorrow's post.
- **Job enrichment:** a job with more challenge, variety and responsibility — the work itself rewards.
- **Job security:** confidence that the firm will keep you — removes fear and builds loyalty.
- **Recognition and praise:** certificates, awards, a mention in the meeting — esteem served directly.
- **Employee participation and delegation:** a say in decisions and real authority to exercise — trust made visible.

Point	Financial incentives	Non-financial incentives
Form	Direct or indirect money — pay, bonus, profit-share, stock, perquisites, pension	No money — status, growth, enrichment, security, recognition, participation
Rungs reached	Mostly lower — physiological and security needs	Mostly upper — social, esteem, self-actualisation
Best when	Basic needs are unmet	Basic needs are met — the top rungs pull
Watch out	Money's effect fades once needs are met	Costs little, but must be genuine to work

Leadership — Influencing People to Will

Supervision watches the work; leadership wins the **heart** behind the hands. A leader is followed **willingly**, not merely obeyed — and the syllabus names three styles of leading.

- **Definition:** leadership is the art of **influencing people** so that they strive **willingly** toward group goals — enthusiasm, not compulsion.
- **Why it matters:** leadership raises morale, builds confidence, guides change and turns a group of individuals into a team.
- **Style is a choice:** the same manager may shift styles with the situation — but each style has a recognisable signature.

Style	What the leader does	Works best when	The cost
Authoritative	Decides alone; orders flow down; close supervision	Crisis, unskilled teams, speed needed	Kills initiative and morale over time
Democratic (participative)	Consults the group; decisions shared	Skilled teams, need for commitment	Slower decisions; not for emergencies
Laissez-faire (free-rein)	Gives full freedom; sets goals, watches results	Experts and self-motivated professionals	Coordination suffers; drift without discipline

EVERYDAY EXAMPLE — THREE TRIP CAPTAINS

An **authoritative** captain announces the route, the stops and the playlist — fast, no debates, but nobody else gets a word. A **democratic** captain asks everyone's preference and books what suits most — happy passengers, slower planning. A **laissez-faire** captain hands everyone the map and says "reach Goa as you like" — perfect for seasoned travellers, chaos for first-timers. The best captain shifts style with the crew and the road.

Communication — The Flow of Meaning

Every function so far — orders, motivation, feedback — travels on one road: communication. When the road is clear, firms run; when it breaks, even good plans die as misunderstanding.

- **Definition:** communication is the **exchange of ideas, facts, opinions and feelings** between people so that both sides understand it alike.
- **The process:** sender → message → encoding → medium → receiver → decoding → **feedback** — the loop that confirms understanding.
- **Why it matters:** it is the basis of direction, coordination and motivation; without it no order, plan or feeling reaches its target.

Formal and informal communication

- **Formal communication:** flows through the **official channels** designed in the organisation structure — orders down, reports up, notices across. **Accountable and documented, but slower.**
- **Informal communication (the grapevine):** arises from **social relationships** — tea-corner talk, group chats. **Fast, honest feedback and belonging — but unverified, and rumours travel it happily.**

Barriers to effective communication — and their remedies

- **Semantic barriers:** the **language problem** — words with many meanings, jargon, badly translated expressions. **Remedy:** simple, clear, common language; confirm understanding.
- **Psychological barriers:** the **mind problem** — premature judgment, distrust, inattention, emotional floods. **Remedy:** listen patiently, keep emotions out, build trust.
- **Organisational barriers:** the **structure problem** — rigid rules, long chains of command, one-way flow. **Remedy:** shorten lines, allow two-way communication, keep policies flexible.
- **Personal barriers:** the **individual problem** — fear of authority, lack of confidence, unwillingness to share. **Remedy:** openness from the top, encouragement, approachable managers.

Barrier family	Typical blockage	Standard remedy
Semantic	Ambiguous words, jargon, technical language	Simple common language; feedback to confirm
Psychological	Distrust, premature evaluation, emotions	Patient listening; trust; emotional control
Organisational	Rigid rules, long hierarchy, one-way flow	Shorter chains; two-way channels
Personal	Fear of superiors; low confidence; withholding	Open climate; encouragement; approachability

- **One line to remember:** every barrier lives either in the **words** (semantic), the **mind** (psychological), the **structure** (organisational) or the **person** (personal) — and every remedy attacks the family it belongs to.

Key Facts & Terms Cheatsheet

KEY FACTS & TERMS CHEATSHEET — UNIT VII (DIRECTING)

Term / fact	What it means	Example / number
Directing (meaning)	Instructing, guiding, motivating, leading people to act willingly	Continuous, every manager, every level
Importance (6)	Initiates action, integrates efforts, motivation, potential, change, stability	Sets the wheels moving
Supervisor	First-line manager; link between workers and management	Fastest feedback channel
Motivation	Stimulating people to act toward goals	Unsatisfied need = the pull
Maslow order	Physiological → security → social → esteem → self-actualisation	Climbed bottom-up, one rung at a time
Climb rule	A satisfied need no longer motivates	Praise stops paying once it is routine
Financial incentives	Pay, bonus, profit-sharing, stock options, perquisites, retirement benefits	Feed the lower rungs
Non-financial incentives	Status, growth, job enrichment, security, recognition, participation, delegation	Feed the upper rungs
Leadership	Influencing people to work willingly toward group goals	Enthusiasm, not compulsion
Authoritative style	Leader decides alone, orders down, close watch	Fast in crisis; kills initiative
Democratic style	Group consulted; decisions shared	Commitment rises; slower
Laissez-faire style	Full freedom; leader sets goals, watches results	Experts thrive; drift risk
Formal communication	Official channels; documented, accountable, slower	Orders down, reports up
Informal (grapevine)	Social network; fast, unrecorded; feedback and rumours	Tea-corner talk
Barriers (4)	Semantic, psychological, organisational, personal	Words, mind, structure, person

Term / fact	What it means	Example / number
Barrier remedies	Simple language, patient listening, short chains, open climate	Match remedy to family

Carry everywhere: direction is continuous and people-facing; a **satisfied need stops motivating**; money reaches lower rungs only; match every barrier to its family before naming the remedy.

Common Errors and Special Cases

COMMON ERRORS & SPECIAL CASES

The mistake students make	What is right	The why / the trap
"Directing means giving orders"	Directing includes **guiding, motivating, leading and communicating** — orders are one small part	The function is people-steering, not people-commanding; the syllabus lists four elements.
"A satisfied need keeps motivating"	A **satisfied need no longer motivates** — the next unmet rung pulls	After the salary covers food and rent, more money alone stops working — esteem and growth pull instead.
"Money motivates at every level"	Money feeds the **lower rungs**; above them non-financial incentives work better	Maslow's climb rule explains why recognition and growth out-pay bonuses at senior levels.
"Laissez-faire means the leader does nothing"	The free-rein leader **sets goals, supplies resources and judges results** — freedom is in the **how**	Absence of control is abdication, not laissez-faire leadership.
"Formal and informal communication are rivals to choose between"	Both **coexist** — official channels carry accountability, the grapevine carries speed and feeling	Smart managers keep both roads open instead of banning the grapevine.
"Barriers are all about language"	Barriers span **four families** — semantic, psychological, organisational, personal	Only the first is linguistic; the others live in minds, structures and persons.

- **Spot the pattern:** this unit's traps are **one-word overstatements** — directing = only orders, money = only motivator, laissez-faire = no leader. The right answers always hold the balance.
- **One special case:** when a question describes an employee already earning well but feeling unrecognised, the correct incentive is **non-financial** — status or recognition — because the lower rungs are already met.

The Whole Chapter on One Page

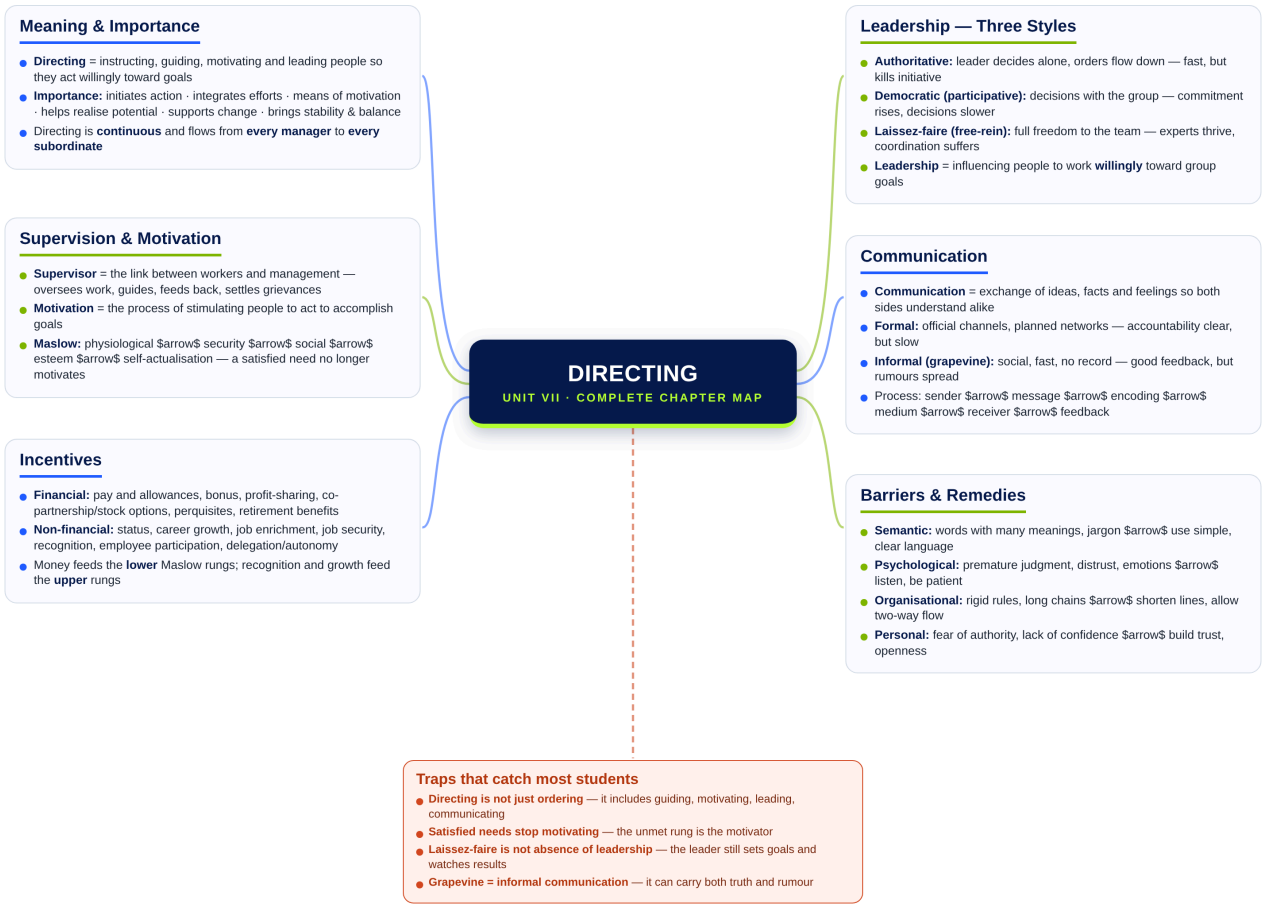


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Whole chapter on one page: meaning and importance, supervision, motivation with Maslow, incentives, leadership styles, communication channels, barriers and remedies, and the four traps that catch most students.

Practice Questions

Q1. Which of the following best describes directing as a function of management?

(A) setting objectives in advance

(B) instructing, guiding, motivating and leading people to act willingly toward goals

(C) grouping activities into departments

(D) comparing actual performance with standards

Q2. In Maslow's hierarchy, the correct order of needs from bottom to top is:

(A) esteem → social → security → physiological → self-actualisation
(B) physiological → security → social → esteem → self-actualisation
(C) security → social → physiological → self-actualisation → esteem
(D) social → esteem → self-actualisation → security → physiological

Q3. An employee earns enough to cover food, rent and safety, and now seeks the manager's recognition through awards. Which rung of Maslow's hierarchy is this employee climbing?

(A) physiological
(B) security
(C) esteem
(D) self-actualisation

Q4. "A satisfied need no longer motivates" implies that:

(A) money motivates everyone equally
(B) the next unmet need becomes the source of motivation once a need is satisfied
(C) satisfied employees stop working
(D) motivation is impossible to study

Q5. Which of the following is a **non-financial** incentive?

(A) profit-sharing
(B) co-partnership and stock options
(C) status and recognition in the organisation
(D) retirement benefits

Q6. A manager makes decisions alone, announces them as orders, and supervises work closely. The leadership style is:

(A) democratic
(B) laissez-faire
(C) authoritative
(D) participative

Q7. A team of experienced research scientists is given full freedom by their leader to choose methods and schedule, while the leader monitors outcomes. The style is:

(A) authoritative
(B) laissez-faire (free-rein)
(C) autocratic
(D) bureaucratic

Q8. Office employees hear about a possible merger through their group chat long before any official notice appears. The channel they used is:

(A) formal communication
(B) informal communication — the grapevine
(C) organisational barrier
(D) semantic communication

Q9. A receiver misunderstands a message because the sender used heavy technical jargon. The barrier is:

(A) psychological
(B) semantic
(C) organisational
(D) personal

Q10. Which barrier-remedy pair is correctly matched?

(A) organisational barriers — use simple jargon-free words
(B) psychological barriers — shorten the chain of command
(C) semantic barriers — use simple, clear common language and confirm understanding
(D) personal barriers — introduce rigid rules for communication

Solutions

Sol. Q1. Directing is the **people-facing** function: instructing, guiding, counselling, motivating and leading so that employees act willingly. Setting objectives is planning; grouping is organising; comparing with standards is controlling.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q2. Maslow climbs: **physiological** (food, shelter) → **security** (safety, job security) → **social** (belonging) → **esteem** (recognition, status) → **self-actualisation** (full potential). Every other option swaps rungs.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q3. Food and rent are met (physiological), fear of the future is gone (security) — the pull now is **recognition and status**, which is the **esteem** rung. Self-actualisation would be seeking one's fullest potential.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q4. Per Maslow, a satisfied need **retires** as a motivator — the **next unmet rung** becomes the pull. It does not mean money motivates equally or that satisfied employees quit; it means motivation climbs.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q5. Status and recognition carry no money — they are non-financial. Profit-sharing, stock options and retirement benefits are all direct or indirect monetary incentives.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q6. Deciding alone, announcing as orders, and supervising closely is the signature of the **authoritative** style — fast in crisis, but costly to initiative and morale over time.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q7. Full freedom of method and schedule with the leader only **setting goals and watching results** is **laissez-faire** — ideal for experts and self-motivated professionals.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q8. News that travels through **social channels** before any official notice — group chats, tea-corner talk — is **informal communication**, the grapevine: fast, unrecorded, sometimes true and sometimes rumour.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q9. Heavy jargon and technical words that mean different things to sender and receiver are **semantic** barriers — the language family. The remedy is simple, common language.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q10. Simple, clear language with feedback belongs to **semantic** barriers — a correct match. Jargon belongs to semantics (not organisational), chain-shortening is the organisational remedy, and rigid rules worsen rather than fix personal barriers.

Answer: (C)

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